DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 3

SEO specialist

Profession 3 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

An SEO specialist improves how a website appears in search results: technical health, content that matches what people search for, and authority from other sites.

What professionals do every day

Runs audits, researches search intent, plans content, fixes technical issues, tracks rankings and traffic, and reports progress in Search Console and Analytics.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Most buyers begin with a search. Good SEO brings steady, low-cost visits that keep working after the work is done.

- Pages search engines cannot find or understand.
- Content that does not match search intent.
- Slow pages and broken links.

Skills you need

- How search engines crawl, index and rank.
- Keyword research and search intent.
- On-page and technical SEO.
- Analytics and Search Console.
- Content strategy and link building ethics.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Google Search Console	Indexing and search performance	Free	Free	search.google.com/search-console
Google Analytics	Traffic and conversions	Free	Paid 360 tier	analytics.google.com
Screaming Frog	Technical crawling	Free (limited)	Paid licence	www.screamingfrog.co.uk/seo-spider/
Ahrefs	Keyword and backlink research	Free tools	Paid plans	ahrefs.com
Semrush	SEO research	Free tools	Paid plans	www.semrush.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Audit one page: title, description, headings, speed.
Intermediate	Research 20 keywords with intent labels.
Advanced	Write one optimised page for one search intent.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Local business site audit.
- **Intermediate:** Blog content plan.
- **Advanced:** Ecommerce category optimisation.

Client-ready portfolio project

The SEO audit and optimisation plan (Part 2 project), applied to a fictional bakery site.

Worked example

Worked example. The phrase 'bakery in Pune' is local intent: the page needs the city, opening hours and a map, not a general history of bread.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

SEO audit and optimisation plan

Business problem: A local bakery's website gets few visits from search. Find the technical and content problems and rank the fixes.

Steps

1. Check that the homepage and key pages are indexed in Google Search Console (official tool).
2. Crawl the site with a crawler (for example Screaming Frog free mode, up to its limit) and list broken links, missing titles and duplicate descriptions.
3. Check page speed on mobile with PageSpeed Insights (official tool).
4. List the target search phrases for each page (for example 'bakery in [city]').
5. Rank the fixes by effort and impact and write a 30-day plan.

Expected output: An audit table with issues, evidence, fix, owner, effort and impact, plus the 30-day plan.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

A good audit starts with indexing (can search engines reach the pages?), then technical health (broken links, titles, speed), then content (does each page match one search intent?). Ranking fixes by impact and effort gives the client a clear first month. The sample audit table lists, for example:

missing meta description on 'Menu' (low effort, medium impact); slow images on the homepage (medium effort, high impact); no local business profile (low effort, high impact for local search).

Common mistakes

- Keyword stuffing that reads badly.
- Buying links from low-quality sites.
- Ignoring mobile speed.
- Changing URLs without redirects.

Freelancing opportunities

- SEO audits and monthly retainers.
- Local business SEO (see Chapter 14).
- Briefs for 'SEO', 'keyword research', 'technical SEO audit'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Google Search Central documentation
- Search Console Help

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